Lena Varga-Holm

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform role at Halden Pay. I have built and operated data pipelines and platform capabilities across streaming, change data capture and warehouse transformation, and I am particularly interested in the role's focus on reusable frameworks that serve analysts, data scientists and product teams.

At Lukovac Freight Hub, I own ingestion and orchestration across Airflow, Snowflake, dbt and Kafka. I designed a shipment-event pipeline processing around 30 million events per day with end-to-end latency under two minutes at p95, and added dead-letter and replay tooling to handle failures without data loss. I also migrated approximately 300 stored procedures to tested and documented dbt models, reducing the nightly warehouse build from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes. Alongside this platform work, I introduced Debezium CDC for the orders database and reduced Snowflake costs through warehouse sizing, auto-suspend and removing unused tables.

My earlier experience at Kovalent Pay is directly relevant to Halden Pay's payments business. I developed PySpark jobs on AWS EMR to reconcile bank settlement files with internal ledgers, reducing finance's manual reconciliation effort from around three days to four hours per month-end. My hands-on cloud experience is with AWS, including AWS EMR, S3, Glue Data Catalog and AWS MSK, and I hold the AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate certification. I also contribute to the data engineering community through SQL teaching, a regional meetup talk and merged fixes to an Airflow provider.

Halden Pay's emphasis on shared platform capabilities, ownership and reducing unnecessary complexity aligns with the way I approach data engineering: build dependable foundations, make them easier to operate, and help colleagues use them effectively. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience could contribute to the Data Platform team.

Kind regards,
Lena Varga-Holm